NSANGIZA Platform

(DUSHAKASHAKE DUSHAKIRA U RWANDA)

"Connecting Rwandan Researchers, Students & Diaspora through Collaborative Knowledge Sharing"

Executive Summary

NSANGIZA is a digital platform designed to empower Rwandan students, researchers, and diaspora communities by enabling seamless research sharing, collaborative communities, and event hosting (both online and offline). The platform aims to address gaps in research visibility, academic collaboration, and community engagement, creating a bridge between local and global Rwandan academic efforts.

Problem Statement

Rwandan researchers, especially students and early-career professionals, face several challenges:

- Limited platforms for sharing research projects publicly
- Minimal collaboration between local researchers and those in the diaspora
- Difficulty accessing research events and communities aligned with their interests
- Lack of centralized, community-driven learning environments

Objectives

1. To share research projects: Allow users to upload and showcase their academic and research work.

2. To host online and physical research events: Provide tools for scheduling, registration, and participant engagement.

3. To create research communities: Establish themed spaces where members can exchange ideas, share knowledge, and collaborate on topics of interest.

Target Audience

- ✓ Rwandan university students
- ✓ Academic researchers in Rwanda
- ✓ Rwandan diaspora professionals and scholars
- ✓ Research institutions, NGOs, and think tanks

Platform Features

1. **User Registration & Profiles:**
   - Account creation (via email or social login)
   - Detailed profiles with research interests, publications
2. **Research Project Sharing:**
   - Upload projects with title, abstract, files, and tags
   - View, like, comment, and follow other projects
3. **Community Forums:**
   - Join or create interest-based communities (e.g., Health, Tech, Environment)
   - Post ideas, start discussions, share links or resources

4. **Event Hosting & Attendance:**
   - Organize events (webinars, conferences, workshops)
   - Include location or Zoom/Google Meet link
   - Allow attendees to register and interact

5. **Knowledge Sharing Tools:**
   - Post blogs, articles, or research notes
   - Q&A threads and discussion spaces
   - File uploads and media support

6. **Notifications & Real-Time Updates:**
- Alerts for new posts, events, or comments
- Activity feeds and trending topics

Technical Overview

- Frontend: React.js (responsive UI for mobile & web)
- Backend: Django REST Framework (Python)
- Database: PostgreSQL
- Authentication: JWT + Google/Facebook Login
- Hosting: Ubuntu VPS
- Video Integration: Zoom API, Google Meet
- Other Tools: Redis (for caching), Celery (for tasks), Elasticsearch (search)

Expected Impact

1. Strengthen Rwanda's academic and research ecosystem
2. Increase visibility and access to research work
3. Build a bridge between local scholars and the diaspora
4. Foster cross-disciplinary innovation and learning

Sustainability Plan

- Partner with universities and research bodies for content and user engagement
- Offer premium features for institutional accounts
- Enable sponsored content or research showcases
- Apply for grants, innovation funds, or diaspora-driven funding